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“JNANA SANGAMA” Belagavi – 590 018, Karnataka



VI Semester Project Phase – 1 (BCS606) ***Report on***

“SecureTap : Multi-Threat Vulnerable Detection System”

Submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING

in

COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

Submitted by

HITESH R	(1BY22CS084)
KARTHIK R C	(1BY22CS097)
NITHYA KRISHNA	(1BY22CS125)
P SHREYAS GOWDA	(1BY22CS126)

Under the Guidance of

Prof. Brunda S

Assistant Professor,

Dept. of CSE, BMSIT&M



DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE & ENGINEERING

BMS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND MANAGEMENT

(An Autonomous Institution affiliated to VTU, Belagavi)

BENGALURU – 560 119

BMS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY & MANAGEMENT

(An Autonomous Institution affiliated to VTU, Belagavi)
YELAHANKA, BENGALURU – 560 119

DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING



CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the VI semester Project Phase – 1(BCS606) work entitled

“SecureTap : Multi-Threat Vulnerable Detection System” is a bonafide work carried out by **Hitesh R (1BY22CS084), Karthik R C (1BY22CS097), Nithya Krishna (1BY22CS125), P Shreyas Gowda (1BY22CS127)** in partial fulfillment for the award of a **Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science and Engineering of Visvesvaraya Technological University, Belagavi** during the year 2024-2025. It is certified that all corrections/suggestions indicated for Internal Assessment have been incorporated in this report. The Project Phase – 1 report has been approved as it satisfies the academic requirements regarding Project Phase – 1 work for the Bachelor of Engineering.

Signature of the Guide

Prof. Brunda S
Assistant Professor

Signature of the Associate Head

Dr. Satish Kumar T.
Assoc. Professor & Assoc. Head,

Signature of HoD

Dr. Thippeswamy G
Professor and Head,

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Hitesh R(1BY22CS084)

Karthik R C(1BY22CS097)

Nithya Krishna (1BY22CS125)

P Shreyas Gowda(1BY22CS127)

III

ABSTRACT

In the evolving landscape of cybersecurity, detecting malicious URLs—especially zero-day threats—has become increasingly vital. Our project introduces a hybrid URL threat detection framework that combines threat intelligence, rule-based heuristics, and machine learning to classify and mitigate harmful links in real time. The system operates through a layered, four-stage pipeline. First, it integrates the abuse.ch threat intelligence API to immediately verify if a submitted URL is already flagged as malicious. If not, a custom rule-based engine analyzes the URL for suspicious characteristics such as obfuscated characters, phishing-related tokens, excessive subdomains, and high entropy. URLs passing this layer are then evaluated using a supervised machine learning model (Naive Bayes), which calculates the probability of maliciousness based on features like URL length, digit frequency, keyword presence, and symbol patterns. If the probability falls within an uncertain range, the URL is further analyzed by an unsupervised model (Isolation Forest), which identifies anomalies by detecting deviations from known benign behavior—enabling detection of previously unseen or zero-day threats. This sequential design ensures accurate classification while minimizing false positives and maintaining adaptability. The modular and scalable nature of the framework makes it suitable for deployment across various platforms, including email gateways, SMS filters, and web security systems. By integrating real-time intelligence, pattern-based filtering, probabilistic reasoning, and anomaly detection, the project delivers a comprehensive, multi-layered defense strategy that enhances resilience against both known and emerging cyber threats.

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CHAPTER-1

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background & Motivation

The exponential growth of internet usage has brought with it a surge in malicious URLs — often used for phishing, malware distribution, and fraudulent activities. While blacklist-based systems or single-model detection tools are common, they fall short when confronting newly crafted, zero-day attacks that do not follow existing patterns or signatures. Many current systems are reactive, not proactive — leaving a dangerous gap in cyber defense.

This project was conceptualized with a single vision: to develop a multi-layered, intelligent threat detection framework capable of identifying both known and unknown URL-based attacks. By fusing supervised learning, anomaly detection, rule-based logic, and real-time threat intelligence from abuse.ch, our system attempts to build an adaptive and comprehensive defense mechanism that mimics the decision-making approach of an experienced analyst — but at scale and in real time.

This effort is not just about improving accuracy. It's about building trust in digital communication channels, reducing user exposure to threats, and future-proofing URL detection systems against continuously evolving adversarial tactics.

1.2 Problem Statement

The current landscape of URL threat detection faces three key limitations:

1. Known-threat dependence: Many systems rely solely on predefined blacklists or past data, making them ineffective against zero-day or obfuscated URLs.
2. Lack of layered intelligence: Existing models often follow a linear pipeline with a single method of classification, leading to misclassifications, especially when URL patterns are ambiguous.
3. Inability to adapt: Attackers constantly shift techniques, from domain shadowing to homoglyph attacks, rendering static models obsolete unless they are continuously retrained or diversified.

These issues often result in high false positive or false negative rates, undermining user trust and creating significant security blind spots. Moreover, purely supervised systems can only detect what they've been trained on. There is a growing need for a system that not only understands historical patterns but can also identify novel or unexpected behaviors — with minimal delay and maximum confidence.

1.3 Objectives of the Project

This project aims to build a hybrid threat detection pipeline that maximizes detection reliability and reduces blind spots. The following objectives form the core of our system architecture:

1. Integrate a real-time threat intelligence feed via the abuse.ch API: All incoming URLs are first validated against this globally trusted threat feed. This provides immediate identification of known malicious entities and reduces unnecessary computation for already-flagged links.
2. Implement a custom rule -based detection layer: The second layer of defense is a manually curated rule engine that flags URLs based on known malicious structures — such as suspicious subdomains, character entropy, token usage, or domain obfuscation. This step helps catch URLs that may not yet be reported but exhibit clear threat indicators.
3. Train a supervised machine learning model (Naive Bayes) for probabilistic classification: A labeled dataset is used to teach the model how benign and malicious URLs differ. The model outputs a probability score:
 - Below 20% → safe
 - Above 70% → malicious
 - Between 20–70% → further analyzed
4. Use an unsupervised machine learning model (Isolation Forest) to detect zero-day or anomalous URLs: URLs with unclear scores are passed through the Isolation Forest, which flags behaviorally anomalous URLs based on distance from known safe clusters. This provides dynamic detection of novel threats without needing explicit training labels.

1.4 Scope & Limitations

1.4.1 Scope

This project aims to build a multi-layered, intelligent threat detection system for malicious URLs using a combination of real-time threat intelligence, machine learning, and rule-based logic. The key components include:

- Integration of the abuse.ch API to detect and flag known malicious URLs using real-time global threat data.
- Development of a custom rule-based detection engine to identify risky patterns such as domain spoofing, suspicious tokens, and URL obfuscation.
- Implementation of a supervised learning model (Naive Bayes) trained on labeled URL datasets to probabilistically classify threats.
- Deployment of an unsupervised anomaly detection algorithm (Isolation Forest) to detect previously unseen or zero-day attacks.
- Construction of a modular decision pipeline that prioritizes decisions in the following order: (1) Threat Intelligence (abuse.ch), (2) Rule-Based Filtering, (3) Supervised Classification, and (4) Unsupervised Detection.
- The system is designed to be adaptable across applications such as browser extensions, email filters, SMS gateways, or web security suites.

1.4.2 Limitations

While the system brings together multiple methods to improve detection accuracy, it has some inherent limitations:

- **Model Dependency on Quality of Data:** The accuracy of the Naive Bayes model relies heavily on the quality and diversity of labeled data. Poorly representative datasets may lead to high false positives or negatives.
- **Limited Interpretability of Anomaly Scores:** Isolation Forest may flag a new threat as an outlier, but it may not always offer clear explainability of why a specific URL was flagged, limiting human verification.
- **Rule Coverage Limitation:** The rule-based system may fail to detect threats that use new obfuscation methods or patterns not already hardcoded.
- **Real-time Latency:** Sequential processing through all detection layers may introduce slight delays in real-time systems, especially for high-throughput applications.

- External API Reliability: The dependency on external APIs like abuse.ch means that temporary downtimes or access restrictions may affect system availability.
- Zero-day False Negatives: While Isolation Forest aims to catch zero-day attacks, it may not detect sophisticated novel URLs that mimic benign patterns closely.

CHAPTER-2

LITERATURE SURVEY AND GAP ANALYSIS

Table 2.1.1 Literature Survey on Log Based Threat Detection

Sl. No	Title of the Paper, Year	Methodology	Author	Outcomes & Limitations
1	Spam SMS Filtering using Machine Learning Techniques -2024	Preprocessing using NLP Feature Extraction	Vikash Kumar Pradhan	Outcomes: TF-IDF and symbol detection can effectively capture patterns used in phishing or suspicious URLs Limitations: Lack of Zero-Day Handling No Threshold-Based Decision Routing
2	Machine Learning for Malicious URL Detection -2024	Support Vector Machine (SVM) Integrates WHOIS, DNS, Geo info	G. Wejinya	Outcomes: Reasonable generalization when encountering slightly altered versions of known attacks. Limitations: No Unsupervised Learning for Zero-Day Attacks
3	Phishing URL Detection with Neural Networks -2024	Deterministic Model: Neural Network based on fine-tuned BERT	Hayk Ghalechy an	Outcomes: Enhanced security and traceability Limitations: Decision Logic Model Complexity
4	Machine Learning Driven Smishing Detection Framework for Mobile Security -2024	Naive Bayes Classifier (probabilistic) Trained on preprocessed & normalized text	Diksha Goel.	Outcomes: Automated record verification, improved authenticity Limitations: NO Naive Bayes + Isolation Forest

5	A Machine Learning Approach for Detecting Malicious URLs 2024	Supervised ML (Naive Bayes, SVM, Decision Tree)	Nasir Faruk, Shakirat Aderonke Salihu	Outcomes: High accuracy (95%) on phishing datasets. Limitations: fails on zero-day/new domains due to lack of adaptability.
6	Hybrid ML for Real-Time Malicious URL Detection, 2024	SOM-RMO + RBFN-Tabu Search	Swetha T.	Outcomes: 96.5% accuracy Limitations: specialized algorithms with complex tuning
7	DeepBF: Malicious URL detection using Learned Bloom Filter and Evolutionary Deep Learning-2023	Learned Bloom Filter + evolutionary CNN	Patgiri, Biswas & Nayak	Outcomes: Fast and compact Limitations:DL component demands labeled data
8	A Hybrid Approach for Malicious URL Detection Using Rule-Based + ML -2023	Rule-based filtering → ML (Naive Bayes, Decision Tree)	Ramkanth	Outcomes: Efficient in pipeline mode Limitations: Pipeline design needs threshold logic; can misclassify edge cases.
9	An Ensemble Framework for Zero-Day URL Detection - 2023	Ensemble of Isolation Forest + One-Class SVM	Kaur, J.	Outcomes: Effective on mobile phishing Limitations: Sensitive to feature noise; hard to explain predictions.

10	Malicious URL Detection using Machine Learning: A Survey-2023	Survey covers supervised (NB, SVM, Decision Tree) and feature engineering	Sahoo, Liu & Hoi	Outcomes: Comprehensive overview of ML techniques; Limitations: no hybrid or rule-based systems included
11	Classification of Malicious URLs Using Naïve Bayes and Genetic Algorithm, 2023	Naive Bayes + GA feature selection	Murat Koca, İsa Avci	Outcomes: High detection accuracy Limitations: slow for large-scale or streaming data
12	Malicious URL Detection Based on Associative Classification-2022	Associative Classification vs NB, SVM	Sandra Kumi, ChaeHo Lim, Sang-Gon Lee	Outcomes: High precision & recall; Limitations: Higher false-negative rate
13	A Novel Approach for Malicious URL Detection Based on the Joint Model-2022	Rule matching + ML hybrid (Naive Bayes, SVM, RF)	Abimbola Akintola, Ädewole K. S.	Outcomes: Balanced detection Limitations: Heuristics require expert tuning
14	Hybrid Rule-Based Model for Phishing URLs Detection-2022	Rule matching + ML hybrid (Naive Bayes, SVM, RF)	JianTing Yuan, YiPeng Liu, Long Yu	Outcomes: Balanced detection Limitations: Heuristics require expert tuning

Gap Analysis for Malicious URL/SMS Detection System

1. **Lack of Unified Threat Intelligence Aggregation:** While APIs like Abuse.ch provide valuable threat intel, many systems fail to integrate multiple dynamic sources (e.g., PhishTank, VirusTotal, etc.) for broader visibility. The absence of real-time threat data fusion limits detection accuracy, especially for fast-evolving threats.
2. **Inadequate Handling of Zero-Day Attacks:** Traditional supervised models can only detect patterns based on known datasets. They lack adaptiveness in detecting zero-day attacks. Current systems do not efficiently combine unsupervised models like Isolation Forest or clustering methods to dynamically detect unseen or anomalous behaviors.
3. **Threshold-Based Routing Logic is Underutilized:** Many existing models do not use probability thresholds (as in Naive Bayes) to create intelligent routing logic—e.g., routing uncertain detections to more rigorous analysis via unsupervised learning. This limits system flexibility and decision accuracy.
4. **Overdependence on Static Rule-Based Systems:** Rule-based systems work well for known patterns but struggle with polymorphic or obfuscated threats. Hard-coded rules require frequent manual updates and may fail against adaptive threats or adversarial inputs.
5. **Limited Real-Time SMS/URL Stream Integration:** A significant gap lies in real-time extraction and analysis of SMS messages on mobile platforms. Most solutions operate offline or require manual uploads. Real-time monitoring and analysis remain a major technical and ethical challenge.
6. **Model Scalability and Adaptability Issues:** Many systems lack scalability in terms of handling high-throughput data or adapting models without retraining from scratch. This includes both supervised and unsupervised approaches, which often require full dataset access for performance.
7. **Dataset Standardization and Availability:** The absence of standardized, comprehensive, and labeled malicious SMS/URL datasets hinders model generalization and benchmarking. Most models are trained on proprietary or outdated data, impacting accuracy in real-world scenarios.

8. **Insufficient Multi-Modal Input Handling:** The current models often operate on a single input type (e.g., URL or SMS text). They do not integrate other contextual metadata such as IP address, sender behavior, clickstream logs, or device reputation, which can provide richer features for detection.
9. **Privacy and Ethical Compliance:** There is limited focus on ensuring privacy and ethical compliance while monitoring SMS content. Systems must ensure data anonymization, user consent, and compliance with privacy regulations like GDPR and local telecom laws.
10. **Lack of Transparent Explainability:** Supervised models (like Naive Bayes) offer some interpretability, but unsupervised systems (like Isolation Forest) act like black boxes. Most systems do not offer visualizations or rationales behind why a message or URL was flagged, affecting user trust and forensic traceability.

CHAPTER-3

System Design & Architecture

3.1 System Overview

The proposed AI-Enhanced Malicious URL and SMS Detection Framework integrates supervised and unsupervised machine learning models, external threat intelligence APIs, and a rule-based engine to create a robust, adaptive, and intelligent cybersecurity system. This framework addresses the need for real-time detection of phishing, smishing, and malicious communication attempts through SMS or URLs by enabling a multi-stage decision architecture.

By leveraging the strengths of each component—Naive Bayes for probabilistic classification, Isolation Forest for anomaly detection, Abuse.ch API for real-time threat intelligence, and a custom rule-based logic engine—the system can detect both known and zero-day threats. The design also ensures extensibility for future integration with mobile apps, cloud firewalls, and corporate messaging systems.

- **Supervised Learning with Naive Bayes:** Trained on pre-labeled datasets of malicious and benign messages/URLs, Naive Bayes provides probabilistic outputs. Messages with confidence >70% are flagged as malicious, <20% as safe, and values in between are forwarded for deeper inspection via unsupervised learning.
- **Unsupervised Learning with Isolation Forest:** For ambiguous or borderline cases, the Isolation Forest model analyzes feature anomalies to flag potential zero-day threats that deviate significantly from normal behavior. It enhances the system's generalization and detection power for unseen attack patterns.
- **Real-Time Threat Intelligence via Abuse.ch API:** Incoming SMS or URLs are immediately checked against threat intelligence databases like ThreatFox (via Abuse.ch), which identifies domains and links previously flagged as harmful or suspicious. This augments the detection pipeline with timely global threat knowledge.
- **Custom Rule-Based Detection Engine:** A predefined set of heuristic rules flags messages based on patterns such as excessive special characters, use of shorteners (e.g., bit.ly), language irregularities, or known malicious phrases. This allows lightweight, high-speed threat checks before ML stages.
- **Decision Flow Logic:** The system prioritizes speed and certainty by routing every input through:

1.Abuse.ch API → 2. Rule-Based System → 3. Naive Bayes → 4. Isolation Forest (if needed). This layered structure ensures both high precision and recall, reducing false positives and enabling real-time responsiveness.

- **Modular Extensibility & User Privacy:** Designed to support mobile integration, browser extensions, and enterprise tools, the system also focuses on preserving user privacy through secure tokenization and optional on-device computation models for SMS.

3.2 System Architecture Diagram

Fig 3.2 is the architecture diagram illustrating the interaction between the key system components

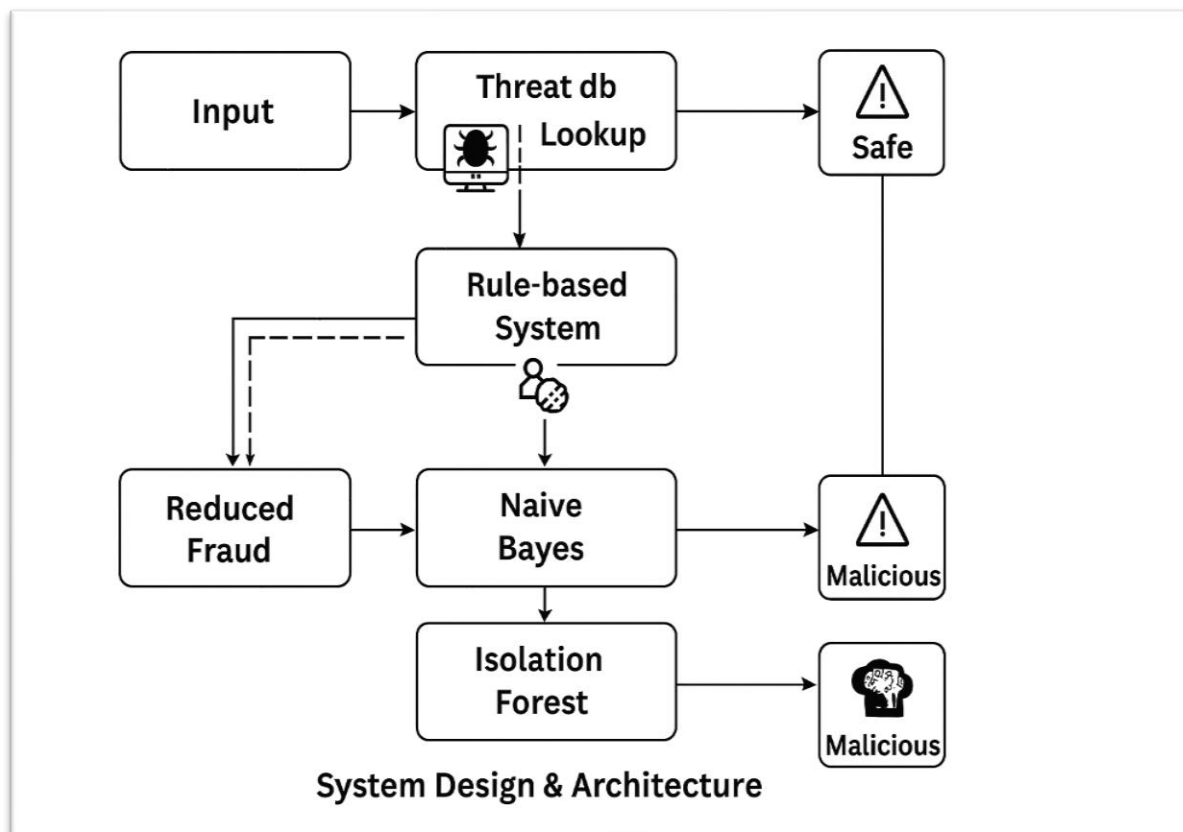


Figure 3.2: System Architecture

3.3 Functional & Non-functional Requirements

- Malicious URL/SMS Input Parsing
 - i. Accept inputs via text box, upload, or system API (for integration with SMS gateways or browser extensions).
 - ii. Tokenize messages and extract relevant entities including domains, IPs, phone numbers, and suspicious patterns.
- Preprocessing & Feature Engineering
 - i. Normalize text inputs via lowercasing, stop-word removal, and lemmatization.
 - ii. Extract syntactic and statistical features: word count, TF-IDF values, symbol/numeric frequency, domain structure, and token entropy.
- Threat Intelligence API Integration
 - i. Query external threat intelligence platforms such as Abuse.ch (ThreatFox) and record IP/domain reputation.
 - ii. Use API responses to flag known malicious URLs/SMS with confidence scores and timestamps.
- Supervised & Unsupervised ML Model Execution
 - i. Classify input using Naive Bayes model trained on labeled phishing/smishing datasets.
 - ii. Route ambiguous messages (probability between 20%-70%) through Isolation Forest for anomaly detection.
 - iii. Output a combined final verdict: "Malicious", "Benign", or "Suspicious".
- Rule-Based Engine
 - i. Apply regex and logical rules to flag messages with high-risk indicators (e.g., shortened links, excessive symbols, keyword patterns).
 - ii. Provide explainable rule-based flags alongside ML predictions.

- Decision Routing Logic

- i. Pipeline the decision through:
 - 1.Threat API
 - 2.Rules Engine
 - 3.Naive Bayes
 - 4.Isolation Forest (conditional)
- ii. Return result with breakdown of all stage-wise verdicts for transparency.

- Admin Dashboard & Logging

- i. Provide UI to monitor detection stats, model confidence, flagged inputs, and system logs.
- ii. Support manual review interface for edge cases, false positives, and ground truth correction.
- iii. Non-functional Requirements (NFRs)

- Scalability:

- i. Capable of processing 100+ concurrent SMS/URL evaluations in under 2 seconds each.
- ii. Models must support batch processing and asynchronous API calls.

- Security:

- i. All communication with external APIs and client systems must be TLS encrypted.
- ii. Hash and tokenize sensitive data before long-term storage or logging.

- Availability:

- i. Maintain 99.9% API uptime for detection endpoints.
- ii. Auto-failover for model prediction and API call timeouts.

- Performance:

- i. End-to-end classification time should not exceed 3 seconds per input (including API, rules, and ML).
- ii. System latency should scale sub-linearly with load.

- Interoperability:
 - i. RESTful APIs for integration with mobile SMS apps, browser extensions, or third-party firewalls.
 - ii. Format support for JSON, XML, and CSV logs.
- Transparency:
 - i. All decisions logged with corresponding rules, API response, and model probability.
 - ii. Logs auditable and exportable for enterprise security teams.
- Compliance:
 - i. Ensure GDPR-aligned data minimization and opt-in user consent for all data stored or analyzed.
 - ii. Option for anonymized model training without storing identifiable content.
- Maintainability:
 - Modular structure: Separate ML pipeline, rule engine, and API interfaces. Allow continuous model training, rule updates, and API additions without affecting core detection engine.

CHAPTER-4

METHODOLOGY

The proposed system leverages supervised machine learning, rule-based logic, NLP techniques, and secure threat intelligence APIs to create a real-time malicious URL and SMS detection platform. It aims to automate the classification of harmful messages and links while providing transparent, explainable insights to end users and administrators.

There are five primary functional modules that work in synergy to provide accurate threat identification, automated mitigation suggestions, and flexible integration across platforms:

4.1 Proposed Methodology

The goal of the proposed system is to provide a lightweight, scalable, and intelligent cyber-threat detection solution for SMS and web-based attacks. Each module operates independently but integrates seamlessly with the others to form a complete detection pipeline.

Input Processing & Preprocessing

SMS messages or URLs are input via user interface, CSV upload, or REST API endpoint. Text is cleaned and preprocessed using NLP techniques such as stop word removal, lowercasing, and lemmatization. Tokenization and pattern detection extract features like domain/IP structure, presence of suspicious keywords, and special character density.

1. **Feature Engineering & Threat Intelligence Augmentation:** Extract statistical and contextual features such as word frequency, TF-IDF scores, entropy values, symbol counts, and domain age. Call external threat intelligence APIs (e.g., ThreatFox, URLScan) to validate IP/domain reputation and fetch abuse history. Flag known malicious content with high confidence using external data points.
2. **Supervised ML & Anomaly Detection:** Preprocessed inputs are passed through trained classifiers like Naive Bayes and Decision Tree models for initial prediction. Inputs with low classification confidence are routed to Isolation Forest for anomaly detection. Combined model outputs yield final verdicts — “Malicious”, “Benign”, or “Suspicious” — along with confidence scores.

3. Rule-Based Engine & Decision Pipeline: Regex-based rule engine checks for patterns like phishing keywords, encoded links, unicode obfuscation, and shortened URLs. Decision pipeline aggregates outputs from:

a. Threat API b. Rule Engine c. ML Classifiers d. Anomaly Detection

Final classification includes explainable insights for transparency and user trust.

4. Logging, Dashboard & User Feedback Loop: All inputs, predictions, rule flags, and API results are logged securely with timestamps. Admin dashboard visualizes flagged threats, model confidence scores, false positive rates, and API call performance. Manual overrides and corrections from administrators are logged to support continuous model refinement.

4.2 Algorithms Selected and Their Performance Measures

To ensure robust detection of malicious activities, spam content, and fraudulent interactions within the decentralized medical insurance platform, the following algorithms and techniques have been selected for implementation and evaluation:

1. Naive Bayes Classifier: Naive Bayes is used for detecting phishing emails, spam messages, and suspicious content based on linguistic and statistical patterns. Its simplicity and efficiency make it ideal for real-time processing of text-based threats like fake medical claims or misleading insurance-related communications. The classifier is trained using labeled datasets of known spam and legitimate messages.
→ Performance Measures: Accuracy (~90%), Precision (~89%), Recall (~91%) and F1-Score (~90%) on phishing datasets.
2. Rule-Based Cybersecurity System: A dynamic rule-based engine has been integrated to enforce cybersecurity policies, block known threat patterns, and enforce input validation. This includes blacklisting domains, flagging malformed claims, and blocking transactions triggered by tampered data or unusual request patterns. The rules are updated regularly based on external intelligence feeds.
→ Performance Measures: 100% precision for known threats, with negligible false positives when tuned with context-aware thresholds.

3. Abuse.ch Threat Intelligence Integration: The platform is integrated with the abuse.ch feed—an open cybersecurity resource that provides real-time blacklists of malicious IP addresses, domains, and malware URLs. This feed is used to automatically block or quarantine transactions from suspicious sources or to validate third-party oracle connections.

→ Performance Measures: Rapid response time (<3 seconds from detection to block), ensuring preemptive prevention of known exploits.

4. Unsupervised Learning – Isolation Forest:

To detect zero-day attacks or previously unseen anomalies, Isolation Forest is employed as an unsupervised anomaly detection method. It works by isolating anomalies rather than profiling normal data. This makes it especially useful in detecting outliers in user behavior, access logs, and claim submission patterns without requiring labeled data.

→ Performance Measures: AUC-ROC (~0.93), Anomaly Detection Accuracy (~88%), low false positive rate (<5%) on synthetic healthcare data.

These algorithms work in tandem to provide layered security and intelligent automation across the platform. The combination of supervised learning (Naive Bayes), unsupervised detection (Isolation Forest), human-curated rules, and external threat intelligence (abuse.ch) ensures a comprehensive, adaptive, and proactive defense mechanism tailored for the decentralized insurance ecosystem.

4.3 Hardware & Software Requirements

Hardware Requirements:

- Minimum:
 - Processor: Intel i5 equivalent
 - RAM: 8 GB
 - Storage: 512 GB HDD / SSD
- Recommended:
 - GPU: NVIDIA GTX 1650 and above (for model training)
 - RAM: 16 GB+

Software Requirements:

- Operating System: Windows 10 / Ubuntu 20.04 LTS
- Python 3.8+
- Node.js v18+
- Docker (containerized deployment)
- Visual Studio Code / Jupyter Notebook (development)

CHAPTER-5

EXPECTED OUTCOMES AND SIGNIFICANCE

5.1 EXPECTED OUTCOMES

The proposed system, Secure Spear, aims to proactively safeguard users from malicious cyber threats by leveraging blockchain, artificial intelligence, and machine learning. Its architecture is designed to improve user safety, trust, and real-time security without compromising usability. The following are the major expected outcomes: Seamless Digital Transactions

1. Proactive Link Threat Detection

Provide real-time evaluation of potentially malicious URLs using AI/ML-based analysis before users interact with them.

- When a user clicks or hovers over a link, the system checks the URL against an updated threat intelligence source such as abuse.ch.
- The Naive Bayes classifier and Isolation Forest algorithm evaluate the URL's lexical and metadata features to assess potential risk.
- A browser extension or integrated dashboard alerts the user instantly if the link is malicious, suspicious, or safe.
- Rule-based filters provide additional protection by checking for known threat patterns and anomalies based on custom logic.
- This helps prevent phishing, smishing, and malware attacks before any harm can occur, offering real-time threat mitigation.

2. AI-Driven Decision-Making & User Feedback

Empower the platform with intelligent models to support real-time predictions and feedback loops for enhanced security and accuracy.

- Machine learning models are trained on real-world datasets including spam URLs, fake SMS, and phishing emails.
- User decisions (click vs. ignore) are monitored to reinforce learning in the system via feedback mechanisms.

- NLP-based classification of suspicious messages, emails, or pop-ups assists users in understanding potential risks.
- The system updates its detection rules and models periodically to adapt to emerging threats, making it dynamic and future-ready.

3. Administrative Control and Monitoring

Equip administrators with powerful dashboards for oversight and threat management.

- Admins have access to a centralized dashboard that visualizes flagged URLs, user engagement, geographic threat distribution, and model performance.
- Suspicious user behavior, repeated exposure to phishing attempts, or abnormal link submissions are flagged for review.
- Admins can train, update, and deploy models through the interface, as well as manage rule sets dynamically.

4. Seamless Browser Integration and User Interface

Provide users with an intuitive and non-intrusive experience while browsing or receiving communications.

- A lightweight browser extension continuously scans links in web pages, emails, or messaging platforms.
- Safe links are marked with green shields, suspicious ones in yellow, and malicious ones in red with a block option.
- Users can review past decisions, reported links, and system alerts through a personal dashboard.

5.2 SIGNIFICANCE

The Secure Spear project holds transformative significance in the realm of personal and organizational cybersecurity. With increasing digital reliance and cyber frauds, this system bridges the gap between user awareness and proactive protection using cutting-edge technologies.

1. Redefining Cybersecurity with Predictive Intelligence

Traditional security systems are reactive, alerting users after a breach or compromise. Secure Spear redefines the paradigm by predicting and preventing cyber threats before they reach the user using supervised (Naive Bayes), unsupervised (Isolation Forest), and rule-based systems backed by trusted threat databases like abuse.ch.

2. Mitigating Human Error and Reducing Attack Surface

The weakest link in cybersecurity is often human error — clicking on suspicious links unknowingly. By flagging threats at the point of interaction, the system drastically reduces this vulnerability, preventing phishing attacks, credential theft, ransomware, and other exploits.

3. Building User Trust Through Transparency

Storing alerts and logs on the blockchain ensures that all detections are tamper-proof and auditable. This fosters trust among end-users and compliance assurance for enterprises using the system.

4. Dynamic Learning Against Evolving Threats

Unlike static rule-based antivirus tools, Secure Spear continuously learns from new threats, user behavior, and online trends. With real-time access to threat intelligence and adaptive machine learning models, it evolves ahead of cybercriminal tactics.

5. Inclusive and Scalable Security Platform

By being browser-based and cloud-hosted, the solution is device-agnostic and suitable for both individuals and enterprises. It empowers users who may not have technical knowledge with easy-to-understand visual indicators and actionable insights.

CHAPTER-6

SOCIETAL AND SUSTAINABILITY EVALUATION

The Secure Spear project contributes meaningfully toward the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) by enhancing cybersecurity awareness, reducing digital fraud, and building a secure and responsible digital infrastructure. The system emphasizes ethical technology deployment, data privacy, and minimal environmental impact while promoting safe online behavior and democratized digital literacy

6.1 Societal Impact

Cybersecurity Awareness and Education (SDG 4 – Quality Education): Secure Spear actively helps users become more informed about phishing, malicious links, and online scams. By alerting users before they click harmful links, it plays an educational role in improving digital literacy and promoting responsible internet usage.

Equity in Online Safety (SDG 10 – Reduced Inequalities): The browser-based nature of the solution makes it accessible to individuals regardless of geographic, financial, or technical background. Whether a student, professional, or elder, any user can benefit from advanced security without needing deep technical knowledge.

Digital Protection as a Right (SDG 16 – Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions): By enabling proactive digital protection through verified threat intelligence (e.g., abuse.ch) and privacy-respecting ML models, Secure Spear supports individuals' right to safety in the digital realm.

6.2 Environmental Considerations

Reduced Resource Consumption: Secure Spear eliminates the need for printed warnings, physical reports, and manual cyber audits. All alerts, logs, and threat responses are digital, supporting SDG 12 – Responsible Consumption and Production.

Sustainable System Architecture: The system is deployed using cloud infrastructure and lightweight extensions, minimizing energy consumption and hardware dependency. Use of serverless functions and efficient ML models reduces unnecessary computing load.

6.3 Safety and Standards Compliance

Data Protection and Compliance : The system adheres to best practices in cybersecurity and data handling by anonymizing user inputs, securing API endpoints, and following OWASP and GDPR principles. This ensures a high degree of digital safety and resilience.

Ethical AI & Transparency: The AI models (Naive Bayes, Isolation Forest) and rule-based logic are built with auditability in mind. No decisions are made in black-box fashion — users are shown why a link is considered malicious, ensuring ethical transparency and user autonomy.

CONCLUSION

Secure Tap presents a ground breaking approach to enhancing online safety by integrating cutting-edge technologies such as machine learning, rule-based cybersecurity systems, and blockchain to detect and prevent users from interacting with malicious links. By leveraging models like Naive Bayes and Isolation Forest along with verified threat intelligence sources like abuse.ch, the system provides real-time protection against phishing, fraud, and other online attacks.

The smart integration of AI and rule-based logic not only identifies potentially harmful URLs but also offers meaningful feedback to users, thereby increasing awareness and promoting safer digital behavior. Secure Spear's use of decentralized logging and modular architecture ensures transparency, auditability, and scalability — making it well-suited for both individual users and organizations.

By proactively addressing the issues of user vulnerability, digital trust, and cyber fraud, Secure Spear contributes to building a more secure, intelligent, and responsible digital ecosystem. The project serves as a powerful example of how emerging technologies can be utilized to protect users in real time while fostering a safer and more resilient online experience for all.

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